

THE STRATEGY BRIEFING

FIVE WAYS TO TRADE GOLD

Position. Swing. Day. Scalp. Transition. What each one costs you in time, capital and nerve — and how to pick the one that fits your life instead of someone else's.



GOLD-LED

12 PAGES

EDUCATION ONLY

⚠ Trading gold, forex and CFDs on margin carries a high level of risk and you could lose more than your initial deposit. 70–80% of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All content is for education only and is not financial advice.

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HOW TO READ THIS

Read the map on page 3 first. It puts all five strategies on one timeline. Most confusion is just two strategies being compared at different holding times.

Every strategy page has the same five blocks: what it is, the numbers, a diagram, the honest trade-offs, and what changes when the instrument is gold.

Then answer the three questions on page 9. Do that before you spend a year on a strategy that was never built for your schedule.

THE MAP

A strategy is three decisions: how long you hold, which chart you read, and how much screen time you can pay. Everything else is detail. Here are the five, on one timeline.

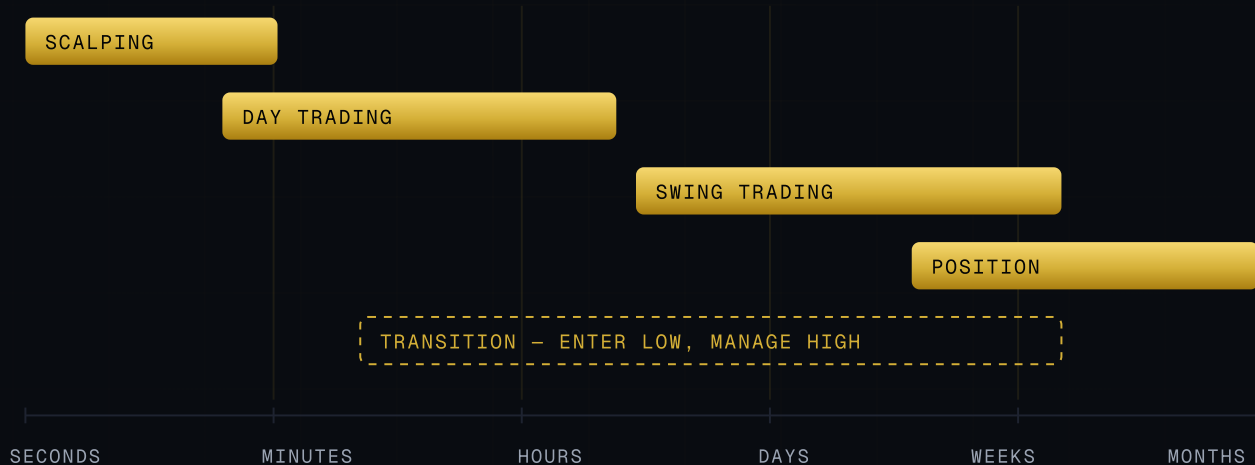


Fig. 1 · Typical holding time. The bar's length is the trade, not the profit.

HOLD LONGER

Wider stop. More capital per trade. Fewer decisions, and fewer chances to be wrong.

HOLD SHORTER

Tighter stop. More trades, more cost, more hours at the screen. The spread starts to matter.

NO WINNER

None of the five is better than the rest. They are trade-offs, and you pick the one you can hold to.

POSITION TRADING

You hold for weeks to months and let the macro do the work.

HOLDING TIME

Weeks-months

CHARTS

Daily · Weekly

REWARD ON RISK

1:5 and up

Gold's big moves come from real yields, the dollar and central-bank demand. A position trader forms a bias from that, then waits for price to come back to a level worth buying. Technicals are only there to time the entry — you are not trying to catch the exact low, you are trying to be in before the trend is obvious.

RISK

1R · wide stop

TARGET

5R or more

ENTRY AT A LEVEL YOU CHOSE IN ADVANCE

→ ONE DECISION, THEN WEEKS OF DOING NOTHING

Fig. 2 · The shape of the trade, not a price forecast.

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Almost no screen time
- ✓ Intraday noise can't reach you
- ✓ One trade can pay for the year

WHAT IT COSTS

- You must genuinely follow the macro
- Wide stops need real capital
- Flat years happen — too few trades

ON GOLD

XAUUSD trends for months when the macro turns, and chops sideways for months when it doesn't. Size for the wide stop or don't take the trade. Trend following is the same shape with the fundamentals removed — price only.

SWING TRADING

You hold for days to weeks and take one clean move.

HOLDING TIME

Days-weeks

CHARTS

1H · 4H

REWARD ON RISK

1:2 to 1:4

The job is one swing. Buy at support, sell at resistance, trade the breakout or the pullback into a moving average — then get out and wait for the next one. The toolkit is small on purpose: structure, levels, candles. Nothing exotic is required, and nothing exotic helps.



Fig. 3 · Schematic. You take the gold leg and leave the grey ones alone.

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ You keep your job
- ✓ Enough setups to build a record
- ✓ Stops small enough for a normal account

WHAT IT COSTS

- You will exit before the big trend
- Overnight and weekend gap risk
- Patience between setups is the hard part

ON GOLD

This is where most SamBangGold setups live. XAUUSD respects 4H structure well enough to trade levels, and moves far enough to pay for the wait. Hold over a Friday close only if you accept the Monday gap.

DAY TRADING

You open and close inside the same session. Nothing is carried overnight.

HOLDING TIME

Minutes-hours

CHARTS

5M · 15M

REWARD ON RISK

1:1.5 to 1:3

You are trading one session's volatility, so trade the session that has some. Set the bias on the higher timeframe before the session opens — long or short, decided in advance — then execute that one direction on the 5M or 15M until the session is done. The long-term trend is not your problem today.

ONE TRADING DAY · GMT

ASIA · QUIET

LONDON

NEW YORK

FLAT BY
THE CLOSE

OVERLAP — WHERE GOLD MOVES

00:00

07:00

13:00

21:00

Fig. 4 · Session map. Trading the quiet hours is paying cost for no movement.

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ No overnight or weekend exposure
- ✓ Fast feedback — you learn quickly
- ✓ Shaped like an income, not a windfall

WHAT IT COSTS

- Hours at the screen, every session
- Slippage on news can beat your stop
- The hours have a salary value elsewhere

ON GOLD

XAUUSD moves hardest in the London–New York overlap, and around CPI, NFP and FOMC. We lock out those release windows: the first move in them is a coin toss, and the spread widens exactly when you'd want to be filled.

SCALPING

You hold for seconds to minutes and take a sliver of movement, many times a day.

WE DON'T RECOMMEND THIS ONE

At retail cost the spread takes most of the edge before you are right about anything, and the other side of your trade is faster than you. It is here so you can rule it out on purpose.

HOLDING TIME

Seconds-minutes

TOOLS

1M · order flow

REWARD ON RISK

Under 1:1

A scalper doesn't care where gold will be next week. The question is what the order book is doing right now — where the resting orders sit, and which side is being taken. Read it, take a few pips, repeat. The edge per trade is tiny, so only trade volume and near-zero cost make it work.

GROSS EDGE PER TRADE



AFTER SPREAD + COMMISSION



Fig. 5 · Proportions are illustrative — the point is which bar is bigger.

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Dozens of chances every day
- ✓ Nothing held past the session

WHAT IT COSTS

- Cost eats the edge
- Feeds, hardware and latency to pay for
- The most stressful of the five, by far

ON GOLD

Gold's spread widens exactly when it starts moving, so this is the hardest version of the hardest strategy. If you still want it, do it inside a proprietary firm — their cost, their feed, their tooling.

TRANSITION TRADING

You enter on the low timeframe and hand the trade up to a higher one.

ENTRY

15M · 1H

MANAGEMENT

4H · Daily

REWARD ON RISK

1:10, rarely

Take the entry where the risk is smallest — a low-timeframe breakout or pullback with a tight stop. If price runs in your favour, don't bank the first target. Move up a timeframe and trail behind the higher-timeframe moving average instead. You are wrong when price closes back through it, and not before.

1H — ENTRY, TIGHT STOP

● IN — RISK 1R

HAND OVER

4H — MANAGEMENT, TRAILING STOP

STOP STEPS UP BEHIND THE 20MA — EXIT ON A CL

Fig. 6 · Two rules: find the entry low, plan the exit high.

WHAT YOU GET

- ✓ Small risk, occasionally enormous reward
- ✓ Turns a normal winner into an outlier

WHAT IT COSTS

- Only a handful of trades ever run
- You must read two timeframes at once
- Giving back open profit is the entry fee

ON GOLD

This is how a 2R intraday long on XAUUSD becomes a 12R hold when the dollar breaks down. Don't go looking for it. Take normal setups, and let the rare one tell you it wants a higher timeframe.

WHICH ONE FITS YOU

Three questions. Answer them honestly now, and you save yourself the year most traders spend on a strategy that was never built for their schedule.

01 Income, or wealth?

Income is X dollars a month. Wealth is X percent a year. They are not the same job.

INCOME

More setups in less time. Lower timeframes, more screen hours. Day trading, short swings.

WEALTH

Fewer setups is fine. Higher timeframes, fewer hours. Swing, position.

02 How many hours do you actually have?

Not the hours you wish you had. If you hold a full-time job, scalping and day trading are not available to you — take swing or position and stop fighting it. If your day genuinely is free and short-term work suits you, the fast end is open.

03 Which shape of edge can you sit with?

Almost every strategy is one of two shapes. Both can be profitable — the maths works either way. Only one of them will let you sleep.

WINS OFTEN, WINS SMALL

High win rate, low reward on risk. Swing trading.

WINS RARELY, WINS BIG

Low win rate, high reward on risk. Position trading.

Most traders who quit did not have a bad strategy. They had someone else's.

WHERE SAM SITS

Swing to intraday, on XAUUSD only. That is the whole mandate.

THE ROUTINE

- 01 Bias from the Daily. Where is gold trying to go this week?
- 02 Setups on the 4H. Levels, structure, the pullback.
- 03 Execution on the 15M, so the stop stays small.
- 04 Hold hours to a few days. Runners get managed up a timeframe.

THE RULES THAT DON'T MOVE

- ✓ Every signal carries entry, stop and three targets
- ✓ Max 1% of the account at risk per setup
- ✓ News windows locked out — CPI, NFP, FOMC
- ✓ Results published in pips and R, never in dollars
- ✓ Losses posted the same day, same card, same size

BUY XAUUSD

SAMPLE

ENTRY	4 352.80
STOP	4 344.20
TP1	4 361.00
TP2	4 369.50
TP3	4 381.00

Illustration of the format only — not a live signal and not a record of one. Risk max 1% per setup. Education only.

WHAT THIS MANUAL WILL NOT DO

It won't turn you into a scalper, and following someone else's timeframe won't either. If page 9 pointed you at position trading, follow Sam for the gold context and trade your own timeframe with it.

THE RANK LADDER

Two routes in, same ranks. Open an HFM account under our link and pay no monthly fee — your money stays in your own account. Or keep the broker you have and pay monthly. Pick one.

GENERAL

\$9/mo

or free with an HFM account

- ✓ Daily gold bias
- ✓ Weekly outlook
- ✓ This manual
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A-TEAM

MOST ENLISTED

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RECAP

Position	Wealth. For people who can't watch a screen. Needs capital and macro literacy.
Swing	Wealth or income, alongside a job. A few hours a day is enough.
Day	Income. Costs you the session, every session. Nothing held overnight.
Scalping	Income, for professionals with professional cost. Not for a retail account.
Transition	A management habit, not a separate strategy. Enter low, exit high.

Before you commit to any of them, settle the three questions: your goal, your hours, and the shape of edge you can hold through a drawdown. Get those right and an ordinary strategy works. Get them wrong and no strategy does.

TAKE THE NEXT GOLD SETUP WITH US

Daily bias, the weekly outlook and two full XAUUSD signals a week — with the losses published next to the wins.

Enlist as General

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